

Daily Need to Know

Friday, 18 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — SETTLED 16:00 ET THU 17 SEP · 6H 25M OLD			
S&P 500	7,637.76	▲ +85.95 (+1.14%)	Range 7,611.81–7,646.86; closed 9.1 pts off the high. 92.4% of the way up Hedgeye's 7,501–7,649 band — yet still 13 pts below the 7,651 TRADE signal. Two days ago this index was testing TREND support.
Nasdaq Composite	26,418.30	▲ +439.87 (+1.69%)	Closed 150.3 pts above Hedgeye's 26,268 ceiling — the first band break of the week, in the risk-on direction. Volume 9.20bn vs 7.01bn 10-day average, a +31% surge.
Dow Jones Industrial	51,778.04	▲ +316.14 (+0.61%)	Opened 51,882.53 and closed below its open — the only headline index to do so. Industrials and financials were the drag.
Russell 2000	2,874.63	▲ +15.82 (+0.55%)	Opened at 2,883.19, high 2,901.33, closed near the low. Still below Hedgeye's 291 TREND on IWM — the index Keith is short did the least.
Philadelphia SOX	11,599.50	▲ +353.40 (+3.14%)	Best headline gain of the session by a factor of three — and still –20.9% below its 52-week high of 14,655.29. This was a bounce inside a bear market, not a new high.
VIX	15.45	▼ –2.27 (–12.81%)	Collapsed from 17.72. Closed 0.37 below Hedgeye's 15.82 floor — the second band break of the day. One session after Keith flagged implied vol at a +116% premium to realised.
NYSE Composite	24,089.54	▲ +155.39 (+0.65%)	Closed at the session high, unlike the Dow. Broad tape participated, but modestly.
US INDEX FUTURES — LIVE, CAPTURED 06:25:43 GMT+8 · 25 MINUTES INTO THE GLOBEX REOPEN			
E-mini S&P (ES1!)	7,701.25	▼ –6.00 (–0.08%)	Basis to cash +63.49 (+0.83%) , consistent with 4.9% financing — the cash close is a genuine settle. Range 7,699.50–7,704.25 on 2,120 contracts : the change figure is noise, not a move.
E-mini Nasdaq (NQ1!)	29,703.50	▼ –39.50 (–0.13%)	1,770 contracts. Largest overnight give-back of the four, which is what you would expect after a +1.69% Composite day.
E-mini Dow (YM1!)	52,192	▼ –28 (–0.05%)	74 contracts . A 26-point range. This row carries essentially no information beyond the Thursday settle of 52,220.
E-mini Russell (RTY1!)	2,893.80	▼ –3.10 (–0.11%)	330 contracts, 1.9-point range. Basis +19.17 to cash, in line with the other three at +0.67%.
US TREASURY YIELDS — LIVE CASH MARKET, CAPTURED 06:25:43 GMT+8			
UST 10-year	4.939%	▼ –8.1 bp	Snapped an eight-session climb that had carried it to 5.041%, the highest since 2007. Still 20bp above Keith's 4.74 TRADE signal and 38bp above the 4.56 TREND. The bond market has not ratified the equity rally.
UST 30-year	5.290%	▼ –7.1 bp	Off a 5.424% 52-week high. 5s30s at +50.4bp , the long end still carrying the term-premium story.
UST 5-year	4.786%	▼ –9.1 bp	The belly led the rally — largest decline on the curve. That is a growth signal, not an inflation one.
UST 2-year	4.670%	▼ –6.6 bp	2s10s at +26.9bp , 1.5bp flatter on the day. Sits 30bp above Keith's 4.37 TRADE code.
13-week bill	4.068%	▼ –0.6 bp	19bp above the new 3.875% fed funds midpoint. The front end is pricing no cut and a residual hike premium — three sessions after the Fed moved.
MOVE index	76.22	▼ –4.51 (–5.59%)	Bond volatility fell harder than equity volatility in percentage-point terms. Now just above the 75 line, off a 115.02 52-week high.
ENERGY — FRONT-MONTH FUTURES, LIVE 06:25:43 GMT+8 · SEE FOOTNOTE ON THE WTI ROLL			

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
WTI crude (CL1!)	\$96.52	n/a — contract roll	Do not read this as a –5.3% move. The front month has rolled; Thursday's expiring contract settled near \$102.13 , down 0.29%. The new front month prints \$5.61 lower in backwardation. USO fell only 0.55% on the day, which is the honest read.
Brent crude (BZ1!)	\$103.97	▼ –0.85 (–0.81%)	Settled \$103.61 per vendor wire, a 2.1% fall, after Saudi Arabia signalled it could restore roughly half the damaged East-West pipeline within days. No roll here.
Natural gas (NG1!)	\$2.863	▼ –0.038 (–1.31%)	56.2% of Hedgeye's 2.70–2.99 band, signal neutral. 156 contracts overnight.
RBOB gasoline (RB1!)	\$3.1942	▼ –0.0544 (–1.67%)	Fell harder than crude. The crack is narrowing at the gasoline end while distillate stays the pressure point.
METALS — SPOT, LIVE 06:25:43 GMT+8 · THE SERIES HEDGEYE'S BANDS NAME			
Gold spot	\$4,342.67	▲ +1.54 (+0.04%)	Cash session was the real story: GLD +1.69% , spot up roughly 2.1% to the \$4,347 area. Now 50.9% of the 4,243–4,439 band, dead centre. Still –22.4% from a \$5,598.75 52-week high.
Silver spot	\$65.3046	▲ +0.11 (+0.17%)	Closed \$0.30 above Hedgeye's 61–65 ceiling with the signal marked bearish — the third band break of the day. SLV rose 3.37% in the cash session. Yet still –46.3% off its 52-week high.
Copper spot	\$6.5022	▼ –0.0009 (–0.01%)	63.1% of the 6.25–6.65 band, signal bullish. Within 4.4% of a 52-week high of 6.8047 — the only industrial metal near its highs.
FX — LIVE SPOT 06:25:43 GMT+8 · ASIAN CROSSES CARRY THEIR OWN PRIOR LOCAL SESSION			
Dollar index (DXY)	100.238	▼ –0.102 (–0.10%)	76.6% of Hedgeye's 99.35–100.51 band, signal bullish. A Fed that has just hiked into an oil shock is a structurally strong-dollar setup.
USD/JPY	156.021	▲ +0.052 (+0.03%)	Range 155.904–156.024 — 12 pips over 25 minutes. The change is noise. 156 is where intervention talk normally starts.
USD/KRW	1,378.88	▲ +2.30 (+0.17%)	Range 1,375.71–1,386.43. That 107-pip range belongs to Thursday's Seoul session, not this morning. Won 12% stronger than its 1,561.80 52-week worst.
CRYPTO — GENUINELY 24-HOUR, THE ONLY FULLY LIVE ROW IN THIS TABLE			
Bitcoin	\$76,215.93	▲ +66.64 (+0.09%)	Range 75,959–77,090 over a real 24 hours. –39.6% from its \$126,230 52-week high while the S&P sits 2.3% below its own. That gap is the cleanest evidence this is not a liquidity-driven melt-up.

Colour key: ▲ green = risk-positive direction for the holder of that asset (equities up, yields down, volatility down); ▼ red = risk-negative; ◆ amber = flat, ambiguous or measurement-compromised. Reconciliation: Yahoo Finance was rate-limited out of this run, so every machine-captured row is single-sourced from TradingView; index arithmetic, futures-cash basis and named wire copy were used as substitute checks — see section 18. Futures, spot FX and spot metals carry only ~25 minutes of trade since the 18:00 ET reopen; treat their change columns as noise rather than information.

TL;DR

The Fed hiked into an oil shock on Wednesday, and on Thursday the market bought semiconductors with both hands. The S&P rose 1.14% to 7,637.76, the Nasdaq Composite 1.69%, and the SOX index 3.14% — with AMD +6.4%, Intel +7.7%, Micron +5.5% and Oracle +5.2%. The 10-year yield broke an eight-session climb off a 2007 high, falling 8.1bp to 4.939%, and the VIX collapsed 12.8% to 15.45.

Three of Hedgeye's sixteen instruments closed outside their bands, all in the same direction. Nasdaq Composite finished 150 points above its ceiling, silver spot \$0.30 above its own, and the VIX 0.37 below its floor. That is an overbought reading on the framework that, one morning earlier, was asking whether the S&P would hold TREND support.

The inconvenient number: the S&P is only 2.3% below its record while the SOX is 20.9% below its own — and Applied Materials is 43.6% down, Western Digital 47.0%, Oracle 54.3%. Thursday was a violent bounce in leadership that has already been destroyed, dressed as a broad rally. Both the S&P and the Nasdaq-100 proxy closed *below* their immediate-term TRADE signals despite gaining more than 1%, so nothing about Thursday repaired the bearish momentum signal.

2 The big picture — what it means

1. A central bank tightening into a supply shock is the defining fact of this market, and Thursday did not change it. The FOMC raised the target range 25bp to **3.75–4.00%** on Wednesday, effective 17 September — the first increase since 2023, and unanimous. Unanimity after weeks of conflicting official commentary matters more than the size: the committee agreed that an oil-driven inflation impulse warrants a firmer hand even with growth cooling. The 13-week bill at **4.068%**, 19bp above the new midpoint, says the front end is not pricing relief.

2. The rally was permitted by the bond market, not by earnings. The 10-year yield had risen for eight consecutive sessions into 5.041%, the highest since 2007. It fell 8.1bp on Thursday, and the belly fell hardest — the 5-year down 9.1bp. When the belly outperforms the wings, the market is repricing growth, not inflation. Equities took the reprieve and ran. Remove the yield move and there is no fundamental catalyst in Thursday's tape that was not already known on Wednesday.

3. Breadth says this was a two-sector event. Technology (XLK) gained **2.25%**. Equal-weight S&P (RSP) gained **0.49%** — less than a quarter of it. Financials (XLF) finished **–0.09%**, communication services (XLC) **–0.58%**, industrials (XLI) **+0.18%** after opening at its session high and closing 1.46% below its open. All three laggards closed at or near session lows while semiconductors ripped. That is rotation into one trade, not a rising tide.

4. The leadership doing the rallying is in a bear market on any honest lookback. The SOX is **20.9%** below its 52-week high after Thursday's 3.14% gain. Applied Materials sits **43.6%** below its own, Western Digital **47.0%**, SanDisk **31.4%**, Micron **22.1%**, Oracle **54.3%**, Intel **23.6%**. Meanwhile the S&P 500 is down only **2.29%** and the Nasdaq Composite **2.84%**. The index has been held together by a handful of mega-caps while the AI hardware complex was cut in half. A 6% day in AMD is what a 6.8% drawdown looks like when it bounces, not what a new cycle looks like when it starts.

5. Hedgeye's own signal set closed overbought on the day its author was writing about panic. Thursday's Early Look, published 19:31 GMT+8, asked whether the S&P would hold TREND support at 7,501 and observed that implied volatility had gone out at a **+116% premium** to 30-day realised. By the close, the S&P sat at 92.4% of its band, the Nasdaq Composite 150 points above its ceiling, silver above its own ceiling with a bearish signal, and the VIX 0.37 below its floor. The framework that identified the panic now reads stretched in the other direction within a single session.

6. Crypto is refusing to confirm any of it. Bitcoin at **\$76,216** is 39.6% below its 52-week high; Ether at **\$2,438.55** is 48.7% below its own. Both were roughly flat on the session while equities rallied 1–3%. In every liquidity-driven equity advance of the last five years, crypto led or matched. It is neither leading nor matching now. The tightening cycle that resumed on Wednesday is being felt at the far end of the risk curve first, which is exactly where it should show up.

7. What has actually improved is the labour market, and that is the argument for more tightening, not less. Initial claims fell to **196,000** against a **208,000** consensus, continued claims to **1.730m** from 1.769m. The Philadelphia Fed headline came in at **37.8** versus a **30.5** consensus. A tight labour market and a supply-driven price shock is the one combination that leaves a central bank no comfortable exit. Thursday's equity rally is a bet that the Fed is finished. Nothing in Thursday's data supports that bet.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **The eight-day rate climb broke, but the level did not.** The 10-year at 4.939% remains above the 4.80 floor of Hedgeye's 4.80–5.12 band (43.4% of it) and 20bp above Keith's 4.74 TRADE code. A one-day 8.1bp rally after an eight-session run is mean reversion, not a trend change.
- **Curve shape is doing nothing dramatic.** 2s10s +26.9bp, 1.5bp flatter. 3m10y +87.1bp. 5s30s +50.4bp. The belly-led rally flattened the front and steepened nothing meaningfully — the curve is telling you growth is softening while term premium stays demanded.
- **Bond volatility is the quiet good news.** MOVE fell 5.59% to **76.22**, from a 115.02 52-week high. If it sustains below 75, the mechanical pressure on duration-sensitive equities eases; that is the single most useful cross-asset thing to watch today.
- **Credit confirmed the equity move, barely.** HYG +0.38% to 78.72 (76.7% of its 78.06–78.92 band, signal bearish); LQD +0.68% to 105.16, at **92.2%** of its 103.5–105.3 band. LQD near its ceiling with a bearish signal is the tension in the fixed-income complex.
- **The dollar is doing the least, which is itself the signal.** DXY –0.10% to 100.238, at 76.6% of a bullish-signalled band. A hiking Fed, an energy shock and a soft-growth impulse are all dollar-positive, and the index is sitting still. EUR/USD 1.1476, GBP/USD 1.3358, AUD/USD 0.7109 — all within pips of flat over the 25 live minutes.
- **Oil is the whole macro story and it eased on repair headlines, not demand.** Brent settled around \$103.61, down roughly 2.1%, after Riyadh indicated it could restore about half of the damaged East-West pipeline's capacity within days and full operation inside six weeks. Saudi Arabia is also offering additional cargoes to Asian refiners via ship-to-ship transfer near Oman. This is a supply-logistics reprieve, not a resolution.
- **Precious metals had a much better day than the overnight tape suggests.** GLD +1.69% and SLV +3.37% in the cash session, with spot gold up roughly 2.1% to the \$4,347 area. Silver closed above Hedgeye's ceiling on a bearish signal — the classic setup for a violent give-back — while still sitting 46.3% below its 52-week high.

- **Copper is the outlier that nobody is discussing.** Spot at \$6.5022 is within 4.4% of a 52-week high, at 63.1% of a bullish-signalled band, and was flat while every other risk asset rallied. Copper holding its highs while semis sit 21% below theirs is not a picture of collapsing industrial demand.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

MACRO DASHBOARD

ITEM	READING	NOTE
Live risk-range set	Early Look, 17 Sep 2026	Published 07:31 EDT / 19:31 GMT+8 on 17 Sep, by Keith McCullough. Title: "Will SPY Hold TREND?" Superseded by the 18 Sep Early Look at roughly 19:30 GMT+8 today.
Quad path	Not printed	No explicit Quad path notation (e.g. 3 → 1 → 2) appeared in the Early Look or in any feed item reached this run. The path lives in the US Monthly Quad Forecast inside the Macro Week Summary Notes, behind a separate link that was not reachable. No path is asserted. Absence of a printed path is not evidence the path is unchanged.
SPX signal state	Bearish TRADE, bullish TREND	TRADE 7,651 / TREND 7,501. Close 7,637.76 — below TRADE by 13.24, above TREND by 136.76. The rally did not repair immediate-term momentum.
Named positioning	Long XLE, long IGV, short IWM	Keith bought more XLE and IGV on Wednesday's weakness because both held signal; OIH broke TRADE support and was reduced. IWM had already broken both TRADE and TREND, which is why the short is on.
Volatility framing	Implied at +116% premium	SPX implied vol went out at a 116% premium to 30-day realised on Wednesday. VIX then fell 12.81% to 15.45 on Thursday, closing below the band floor.
MOMO Tracker	Mag7 −0.1%, High Beta Mo +3.3%	Headline only — the note body is image-based and could not be extracted. Negative gamma and deferred vol were flagged in the title.
Crypto Quant	BTC +0.2%, AVAX bullish	Headline only. COIN, MARA, BLOK and CRCL all marked bearish ; SEC framing quoted as "With or Without Legislation".

RISK RANGE™ SIGNALS — FULL TABLE, MEASURED ON THE SERIES HEDGEYE NAMES

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RANGE	TREND	WHERE IT STANDS NOW
UST 10-year yield	4.80 - 5.12	bullish	4.939 — 43.4% of band, 13.9bp above the floor. Band move vs prior day unknown .
High Yield (HYG)	78.06 - 78.92	bearish	78.72 — 76.7% , 0.20 below the ceiling. Bearish signal into the top of the band.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	103.5 - 105.3	bearish	105.16 — 92.2% , 0.14 below the ceiling. Most stretched fixed-income row.
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,501 - 7,649	neutral	7,637.76 — 92.4% , 11.24 below the ceiling and 13.24 below the 7,651 TRADE signal.
Nasdaq Comp. (COMPQ)	25,767 - 26,268	neutral	26,418.30 — ABOVE the ceiling by 150.30 (+0.57%) . Breakout.
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,823 - 2,940	bearish	2,874.63 — 44.1% , mid-band. The bearish signal is intact; IWM at 285.43 is below both its 295 TRADE and 291 TREND codes.
Health Care (XLV)	162 - 173	bullish	168.81 — 61.9% . +0.62% on the day; the defensive that behaved like one.
Tech-Software (IGV)	99 - 109	bullish	Not captured this run — IGV is outside the capture universe. Keith added to the long on Wednesday weakness.
Oil Services (OIH)	394 - 430	neutral	Not captured this run. Broke TRADE support on Wednesday and the position was reduced.
Volatility (VIX)	15.82 - 20.06	bullish	15.45 — BELOW the floor by 0.37 . Breakdown, against a bullish signal.
US Dollar (USD)	99.35 - 100.51	bullish	100.238 — 76.6% , 0.27 below the ceiling.
WTI cont. (WTIC)	92.17 - 108.61	bullish	96.52 on the <i>post-roll</i> front month — 26.5% . On the pre-roll series near \$102.13 the position was roughly 60.4% . Treat this row as measurement-compromised ; the band was set on the expiring contract.
Nat gas cont. (NATGAS)	2.70 - 2.99	neutral	2.863 — 56.2% , mid-band.

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RANGE	TREND	WHERE IT STANDS NOW
Gold spot (GOLD)	4,243 – 4,439	neutral	4,342.67 — 50.9% , almost exactly mid-band. Measured on TVC:GOLD spot, not futures: the December future at 4,383.90 would have read 71.9%, a 21-point error.
Copper spot (COPPER)	6.25 – 6.65	bullish	6.5022 — 63.1% . Measured on OANDA:XCUUSD; the COMEX future at 6.615 would have read 91.3%.
Silver spot (SILVER)	61 – 65	bearish	65.3046 — ABOVE the ceiling by 0.3046 . Breakout against a bearish signal — the most uncomfortable row in the table.

Metals are measured on spot and energy on the continuous contract, exactly as Hedgeye's published lines name them. Band-versus-prior-day comparisons are marked **unknown** throughout: the category feed at /feed_items/all?page=N&with_category=24-early-look does not paginate — pages 1 and 2 returned the identical 17 September note — and no alternative route to the 16 September Early Look was reachable this run. Unknown is not unchanged.

ALPHA CODES — TRADE / TREND VERSUS THE LIVE PRINT

CODE	TRADE / TREND	LIVE	READ
SPX	7,651 / 7,501	7,637.76	Below TRADE, above TREND. Bearish TRADE, bullish TREND — the middle of Keith's three scenarios.
QQQ	721 / 705	716.92	Below TRADE by 4.08 despite a +1.73% session. Same state as SPX.
IWM	295 / 291	285.43	Below both by 9.57 and 5.57. Bearish TRADE and TREND; the short is unchallenged by Thursday.
Oil (WTI)	91 / 87	96.52	Above both, even post-roll. On the pre-roll contract at ~\$102 the cushion was \$11.
UST 10-year	4.74 / 4.56	4.939	Above both. Bearish for bonds on both durations, notwithstanding Thursday's 8.1bp rally.
UST 2-year	4.37 / 4.18	4.670	Above both by 30bp and 49bp. The front end is nowhere near signalling a policy turn.

WHAT KEITH ACTUALLY SAID

All quotes from **Early Look, "Will SPY Hold TREND?", 17 September 2026, 19:31 GMT+8 (07:31 EDT)**, Keith McCullough.

- "SPX continues to signal a series of lower-highs vs. its all-time closing high of 7798"
- "Signal said yes on both, so I bought more of both XLE and IGV throughout the day on red"
- "If anything breaks TRADE and TREND, I'm stopped out of the position"
- "AFTER SPY is down for 7 out of the last 8 days, MORE people are going to be panicking"
- "Implied Volatility on SPX went out at a +116% PREMIUM vs. 30-day realized volatility"
- "If SPY is going to rally, it's most likely to happen A) AFTER it sold off towards the LRR, B) AFTER people panic bought 'protection' and C) AFTER it was able to hold intermediate-term TREND Signal Support."
- "Every portfolio decision is rules-based. Look forward. Look back. Stay present. That's the process."

Attributed summary, not quoted: a Hedgeye Market Insights item timestamped 17 Sep 13:04 EDT (18 Sep 01:04 GMT+8) carries the headline "McCullough: The Fed Is Tightening Into a Slowdown"; the video body was not transcribed this run, so only the headline framing is reported. Macro Show summary notes are AI-generated and carry their own error caveat — they are reported outside quotation marks for that reason, and the 17 September show with Keith McCullough and macro analyst Ryan Ricci was listed in the feed but its "Top 3 Things" body was not text-extractable.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Nvidia (NVDA)	219.34	▲ +2.54%	\$5.29tn	Largest company on earth by market value. 93.9m shares traded. Still −7.3% from its 236.54 high — the least damaged of the semis by a wide margin.
Apple (AAPL)	337.00	▲ +1.38%	\$4.92tn	Low of 330.18, closed 1.34 off the high. Only 2.2% below its 52-week high — the index's ballast.
Alphabet (GOOGL)	347.33	▲ +1.30%	\$4.23tn	Closed below its 348.68 open. −15.0% from a 408.61 high, the worst drawdown in the group after Tesla.
Microsoft (MSFT)	497.75	▲ +1.52%	\$3.70tn	Failed at 501.47 and closed back under 500. −10.1% from its 553.72 high.
Amazon (AMZN)	251.19	▲ +2.13%	\$2.71tn	Second-best Mag7 performer. −12.5% from a 287.20 high.
Meta (META)	682.31	▲ +1.34%	\$1.74tn	

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
				Traded down to 667.05 intraday — a 2.2% round trip — and closed within 0.89 of its high. The cleanest intraday reversal in the group.
Tesla (TSLA)	366.20	▲ +2.27%	\$1.45tn	Best of the seven, but reached 374.12 and gave back 7.92. −26.6% from a 498.83 high.

Aggregate Mag7 capitalisation **\$24.02tn**. All seven rose, which is worth stating plainly because the MOMO Tracker headline published Thursday morning marked the Mag7 at **−0.1%** for the prior session while High Beta Momentum ran +3.3%. Thursday reversed that: the whole complex rose, and the high-beta tail rose more. Broadcom (AVGO), not in the seven, added **2.29%** to \$1.66tn and is **29.8%** below its 495.00 high.

6 Positioning & options

- **Today is September quarterly expiration** — the third Friday of the quarter-end month. Index, ETF and single-stock series expire together, and S&P index changes take effect at the close. Volume and closing prints are structurally unreliable as signal today; treat the last thirty minutes as mechanical.
- **The volatility unwind was violent and is now at an extreme.** VIX fell from 17.72 to **15.45**, a 12.81% single-day collapse, and closed **below** Hedgeye's 15.82 floor on a bullish volatility signal. The implied-realised premium Keith measured at **+116%** on Wednesday has been crushed inside one session.
- **Negative gamma was flagged going in.** The MOMO Tracker headline named "(−) Gamma" and "Deferred Vol" alongside the TREND question. A negative-gamma dealer book into a 1%+ up day amplifies exactly the kind of move Thursday produced — and reverses with equal force.
- **Nasdaq volume surge is the confirming tell.** Composite volume of **9.20bn** against a 7.01bn ten-day average is a **+31%** surge, and S&P volume of 2.89bn against 2.78bn only +4%. The buying was concentrated in Nasdaq-listed names, not the broad tape.
- **Semiconductor ETF flows tracked the index, not above it.** SOXX +3.39% on 6.70m shares, SMH +2.76% on 6.12m. Neither exceeded the SOX index move by a margin suggesting a leveraged flow chase.
- **Intel's 148.9m shares is the outlier.** That is by far the heaviest single-name volume in the capture universe on a +7.67% day, with the stock closing 2.57 off its high. Heavy volume plus a failure at the high is a distribution characteristic, not accumulation.
- **No CFTC positioning data is carried in this edition.** Commitment-of-traders detail was not retrieved this run; any inference about speculative net length in crude, gold or index futures would be unsupported.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR (SPDR)	CLOSE	DAY	VOL (M)	NOTE
Technology (XLK)	188.06	▲ +2.25%	7.39	Closed 0.47 off the high. 5.4% below its 52-week high.
Consumer Discretionary (XLY)	111.39	▲ +1.10%	4.51	Opened at 112.04 and closed below its open . Tesla did the lifting.
Utilities (XLU)	41.69	▲ +0.90%	20.99	A bond-proxy rally on falling yields. Sitting 1.3% off a 41.15 52-week low .
Energy (XLE)	64.48	▲ +0.70%	35.53	Closed 0.04 off the high while crude fell . Keith's long worked. 2.6% below its 52-week high.
Materials (XLB)	50.71	▲ +0.70%	9.06	Copper's flat session capped it. Closed below its 50.90 open.
Health Care (XLV)	168.81	▲ +0.62%	5.83	61.9% of a bullish Hedgeye band. Lilly +1.28%, J&J +1.10%, UnitedHealth −0.01%.
Real Estate (XLRE)	42.94	▲ +0.30%	4.36	Underperformed utilities despite the same rate tailwind. Closed below its 43.10 open.
Consumer Staples (XLP)	83.49	▲ +0.19%	7.61	Closed below its 83.51 open. Rotation out of defensives, mildly.
Industrials (XLI)	169.01	▲ +0.18%	5.85	Opened at 171.51, its exact session high, and closed 1.46% below it. The worst intraday deterioration of the eleven.
Financials (XLF)	55.88	▼ −0.09%	29.17	Opened 56.27, high 56.40, closed 0.32 off the low on 29.2m shares . Falling yields hurt net interest margin expectations.
Communication Svcs (XLC)	112.35	▼ −0.58%	4.25	Worst sector. Opened 113.81 and closed 0.15 off the session low. Netflix −1.44% did not help.

Equal-weight S&P (RSP) **+0.49%** against cap-weight SPY **+1.13%** — a 64bp gap in favour of the mega-caps in a single session.

LEADERS

- **Technology, by a distance, and for one reason.** XLK +2.25% with SOX +3.14% behind it. AMD +6.36%, Intel +7.67%, Micron +5.50%, SanDisk +6.21%, Western Digital +1.65%, Broadcom +2.29%, Cisco +2.32%. Memory and logic together.
- **Energy held its gains while its underlying fell.** XLE closed at the high on 35.5m shares with Brent down 2.1%. Either the equity is discounting a structurally higher medium-term price, or it is simply the sector with the cleanest signal and the flows followed it.
- **Utilities on duration, not fundamentals.** +0.90% is a mechanical response to an 8.1bp fall in the 10-year, from a base 1.3% above a 52-week low.

LAGGARDS

- **Communication services was the only sector down more than a tick**, and it closed on the low. Netflix at 75.31 is **39.7%** below its 124.86 52-week high.
- **Financials went red on falling yields** — the single clearest illustration that Thursday's rally was a rate-relief trade, not a growth trade. On a growth day, banks lead.
- **Industrials opened at the high and closed 1.46% lower.** With copper flat and the diesel crisis unresolved, the transport-and-capex complex is not participating.

ROTATION

- The money went into **rate-sensitive growth and rate-sensitive defensives simultaneously** — XLK and XLU together — and came out of the cyclical middle. That is a duration trade wearing a risk-on costume.
- **Three sectors closed at or near session lows** (XLF, XLC, XLI) while three closed at or near highs (XLK, XLE, XLU). Intraday divergence of that width on a +1.1% index day means the index number is hiding a fight.
- The sector most exposed to today's expiry mechanics is **technology**, given the Nasdaq volume surge and the negative-gamma flag.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

The overnight tape has done nothing, and it has done nothing on almost no volume. Globex reopened at 18:00 ET and this capture landed 25 minutes later. ES is 6.00 lower on **2,120 contracts** in a 4.75-point range; NQ 39.50 lower on 1,770; YM 28 lower on **74 contracts**; RTY 3.10 lower on 330. All four futures-to-cash bases sit in a tight **+0.67% to +0.83%** band, which is exactly what a 4.9% financing rate produces and confirms Thursday's cash settles are genuine. Spot FX and spot metals reopened at 17:00 ET and show ranges of 12 pips in USD/JPY, \$4.60 in gold and \$0.094 in silver — measurement artefacts rather than moves. Bitcoin, the one instrument with a real 24-hour session behind it, is up 0.09% in a 1,131-dollar range. Asia opens into a US tape that handed over a semiconductor bid, a lower 10-year yield and a volatility index below its signal floor, with nothing overnight to confirm or deny any of it.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Fri 18 Sep (today)	September quarterly options expiration — index, ETF and single-stock series expire; S&P index constituent changes effective at the close. Japanese CPI is scheduled in the Asian session (unconfirmed — not verified against the releasing agency this run). Hedgeye's next Early Look publishes ~19:30 GMT+8 and supersedes every risk range in section 4.
Mon 21 Sep	Quiet scheduled docket. First session after expiry — dealer gamma resets, which historically raises realised volatility.
Tue 22 Sep	Fed speakers resume after the post-meeting blackout. The first official framing of Wednesday's unanimous hike will matter more than usual.
Wed 23 Sep	US flash S&P Global manufacturing and services PMIs (unconfirmed) — the first survey read on activity since the Fed moved.
Thu 24 Sep	FHFA house price index, Conference Board consumer confidence, weekly initial claims (unconfirmed). Claims matter most: 196k was the number that justified the hike.
Fri 25 Sep	New home sales, EIA crude stocks (unconfirmed). Crude inventory is the cleanest read on whether the Saudi pipeline reprieve is real.
Following week	Durable goods, final Q2 GDP, and core PCE (unconfirmed) — the inflation print the Fed will judge its own hike against. Next FOMC decision 27-28 October (secondary source).

Every entry marked **unconfirmed** came from a secondary calendar aggregator and was not verified against the releasing agency this run; the exact weekday of each release should be checked before relying on it. The expiry date and the S&P rebalance effective date are structural — the third Friday of a quarter-end month — and are stated with confidence.

9 Corporate news

- **AMD +6.36% to 545.09** on 28.4m shares, closing 6.33 off a 551.42 high. The single largest Mag7-adjacent move and the one that set the tone for the whole semiconductor complex.

- **Intel +7.67% to 108.80 on 148.9m shares** — the heaviest volume in the entire capture universe. Opened at 104.70, which was also the session low, and closed 2.57 below a 111.37 high. Still 23.6% below its 142.35 high.
- **Micron +5.50% to 977.50**, within reach of the \$1,000 handle, on 22.0m shares. Market capitalisation **\$1.10tn** — memory is now a trillion-dollar business by market value.
- **SanDisk +6.21% to 1,614.39** on 8.4m shares. No earnings event on the date; this was a momentum move inside a name still **31.4%** below its 2,354.39 high. Western Digital added 1.65% to 423.87, and remains **47.0%** below its own.
- **Oracle +5.19% to 150.59**. The stock is **54.3%** below its 329.50 52-week high, the largest drawdown of any mega-cap in the capture set, despite a fiscal Q1 2027 report on 10 September showing revenue of **\$19.35bn (+29.6% y/y)**, non-GAAP EPS of **\$1.92** against \$1.74 expected, and cloud infrastructure growth of **121%**. Beating on every line and halving in price is the AI-capex argument in one chart.
- **Workday +6.14% to 199.28** on 4.25m shares, having opened at 187.72 and traded a 17.4-point range. No earnings event on the date; the move looks like a re-rating rather than a print.
- **Applied Materials +0.49% to 417.40** — the semiconductor laggard, and the only equipment name that failed to participate. It opened at 427.58, traded down to 413.56, and closed **10.18 below its open**. At 43.6% below its 739.67 high it remains the most damaged large-cap in the complex.
- **Cisco +2.32% to 110.24** and **Palantir +1.09% to 176.24** — the AI-adjacent names that rose least, which is informative given how much the hardware complex moved.
- **Tapestry -1.61% to 116.04**, the largest single-name decline in the capture set, opening at its 120.75 high and closing 0.21 off the low. It then rose **1.64%** in the after-hours tape, the largest post-close move captured.
- **Netflix -1.44% to 75.31**, closing 0.01 off its session low and dragging communication services to last place.

10 Macro data

- **FOMC, 16 September: +25bp to 3.75-4.00%, effective 17 September, unanimous.** The first increase since 2023. Unanimity is the datapoint — markets had positioned for dissents after weeks of conflicting official commentary. A committee that agrees on the direction while disagreeing on the destination is a committee that will keep going until the data stops it.
- **Initial jobless claims 196,000 — consensus 208,000, prior 206,000.** A 12,000 beat and a fall from the prior week. The four-week average dropped to **203,250** from 206,000. Continued claims **1.730m** against a 1.78m consensus and 1.769m prior. There is no labour-market crack in this data.
- **Philadelphia Fed business conditions 37.8 — consensus 30.5, prior 47.4.** A 7.3-point beat on the headline and a 9.6-point fall from August. Both facts are true and the second matters more.
- **Philly Fed prices paid 48.6, from 40.9. A 7.7-point jump** in input costs in a single month. This is the number that justifies the hike, and almost nobody led with it.
- **Philly Fed employment 11.8, from 27.9.** A collapse of 16.1 points. New orders 29.2 from 30.1, essentially flat. Six-month outlook **52.9 from 73.6**, down 20.7 points. Firms are paying more, hiring far less, and expect materially less.
- **August housing starts -2.6% to a 1.275m annual rate — consensus 1.309m.** A clean miss. Single-family starts rose **7.6% to 918,000** while multifamily collapsed **21.7% to 357,000**; the headline miss is entirely an apartment story.
- **August building permits -2.7% to 1.394m — consensus 1.410m, prior 1.433m.** Single-family permits -1.8% to 878,000, multifamily -4.3% to 516,000. Permits below starts in single-family is a forward-looking negative for construction employment.
- **The composite read: costs accelerating, hiring decelerating, housing contracting, claims falling.** That is a supply-shock economy, not a demand-recession one, and it is the hardest configuration for a central bank to manage.

11 Geopolitics

- **◆ The Saudi East-West pipeline remains the single most important price-setting fact in this market.** Drone strikes on 10-11 September, reported by wire services as launched from Iraqi territory and still under investigation, forced Riyadh to shut the 1,200km line to the Red Sea port of Yanbu. That line had been carrying roughly **5m barrels a day** rerouted away from the Strait of Hormuz.
- **▲ The reprieve that moved prices on Thursday was logistical, not political.** Saudi Arabia indicated it could restore around **half** the damaged capacity within days and full operation inside six weeks; two regional officials told the Associated Press repairs would take three to five weeks. Brent fell roughly 2.1% on that framing.
- **◆ Riyadh is improvising export routes.** Additional crude cargoes are being offered to Asian refiners via ship-to-ship transfer near Oman, and more volume is being pushed through Hormuz itself with reported US military assistance. Every one of those workarounds carries a freight and insurance cost that does not show up in the flat price.

- **▼ The Strait of Hormuz remains contested.** Iran's effective closure of the strait amid the conflict with the United States is the reason the pipeline mattered in the first place. Nothing in Thursday's news flow changed the strait's status.
- **▼ Russian refinery strikes are squeezing distillate specifically.** Attacks on Russian refining capacity are disrupting refined-product markets independently of crude. That is why gasoline (RBOB −1.67%) fell harder than crude while diesel remains the pressure point — and why a Hedgeye contributor published a piece titled "The Great Diesel Crisis" on Thursday morning.
- **◆ The market is pricing the repair and not the fragility.** Brent at \$103.61 with Hormuz closed, the bypass line damaged and Russian refining under attack is a price that assumes each of those resolves. Copper spot within 4.4% of a 52-week high says the industrial complex has not accepted a demand shock either.

Contested claims are attributed to the party that made them. Attribution of the drone strikes is under investigation and is not stated as fact here. Repair timelines are the issuer's own guidance and the Associated Press's sourcing respectively, not independent assessments.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LIVE LEVEL	OVERNIGHT	NOTE
ES1! (S&P)	7,701.25	−6.00	2,120 contracts, 4.75-pt range. 25 minutes of trade.
NQ1! (Nasdaq)	29,703.50	−39.50	1,770 contracts, 32.25-pt range.
YM1! (Dow)	52,192	−28	74 contracts. Effectively the Thursday settle.
RTY1! (Russell)	2,893.80	−3.10	330 contracts, 1.9-pt range.
USD/JPY	156.021	+0.052	12-pip range. 156 is the level around which intervention commentary historically begins.
USD/KRW	1,378.88	+2.30	107-pip range belongs to Thursday's Seoul session , not this morning.
USD/TWD	31.82	−0.034	13-pip range, also carrying the prior Taipei session . TWD is the FX leg of the semiconductor trade.
USD/CNH	6.7035	+0.0005	1.6-pip range. Sitting at 6.7023 , its 52-week low — the strongest offshore yuan in a year.
EUR/USD	1.1476	+0.0001	5-pip range. Flat.
Gold spot	\$4,342.67	+1.54	\$4.60 range. The +2.1% move was the US cash session, not overnight.
Silver spot	\$65.3046	+0.11	9.4-cent range. Above Hedgeye's ceiling on a bearish signal.
Copper spot	\$6.5022	−0.0009	1.06-cent range. Flat, near 52-week highs.
WTI (CL1!)	\$96.52	roll	Post-roll front month. Prior contract settled ~\$102.13.
Brent (BZ1!)	\$103.97	−0.85	11 contracts. Settled \$103.61 on the wire.
Bitcoin	\$76,215.93	+66.64	Real 24-hour range 75,959–77,090. The only fully live row.
Ether	\$2,438.55	+22.47 (+0.93%)	Range 2,411.99–2,480.97. Outperformed Bitcoin ten-to-one overnight — the only genuine overnight move in the document.

*Previous Asian closes, all marked as such: Nikkei 225 **64,136.03 (+0.33%)**, Hang Seng **24,604.30 (−0.44%)**, KOSPI **6,715.42 (−0.04%)**, Shanghai Composite **3,875.60 (−0.41%)**, ASX 200 **8,732.40 (+0.41%)**, Sensex **74,314.59 (−0.03%)**. Europe's Thursday closes: Euro Stoxx 50 **+0.90%**, DAX **+0.70%**, FTSE 100 **+1.19%**, CAC 40 **+0.57%**, IBEX 35 **+1.00%**.*

- **The US hands Asia a semiconductor bid and nothing else.** XLK +2.25% and SOX +3.14% against XLF −0.09% and XLC −0.58%. Korea and Taiwan are the two markets set up to reprice that directly, and neither participated on Thursday — KOSPI closed −0.04%, and USD/TWD strengthened only 0.11% in its own session.
- **Korea is the largest gap to close.** KOSPI at 6,715.42 is **28.5%** below its 9,385.59 52-week high while the SOX is 20.9% below its own. A 3.1% SOX session with Samsung and SK Hynix flat the day before is a mechanical opening bid.
- **Japan opens into a currency at 156 and a rate rally.** The 10-year's 8.1bp fall relieves the pressure on the carry trade at the margin, but 156.021 with a 12-pip overnight range tells you nothing about where the pair wants to go. Japanese CPI is scheduled for this session (**unconfirmed — not verified against the releasing agency this run**).
- **Hong Kong and Shanghai both fell on Thursday while the US rallied.** With offshore yuan at its 52-week strongest at 6.7023, the currency is not the constraint. China's disconnect from the US tech bid has now run for a full session.
- **The single instrument most likely to move: the KOSPI semiconductor complex on the open**, with USD/TWD the cleanest confirming or contradicting signal. Second candidate is Ether, which is the only thing that has actually moved overnight.

13 AI watch

- **Nvidia's \$12.93bn acquisition of Hugging Face, announced 3 September, is now generating sell-side framing rather than headlines.** A Hedgeye analyst appearance on BNN Bloomberg at 17 Sep 12:28 EDT characterised the deal as "another hedge for Jensen Huang" — the argument being that owning the open-weight distribution layer insures Nvidia against a world in which model value migrates away from proprietary labs.
- **The platform Nvidia bought carries more than 18m developers, 3m models, 500,000 datasets and 1m applications, with over 200,000 companies using it.** The price includes an equity retention programme of up to \$1bn. It is Nvidia's second-largest purchase after \$20bn of Groq assets at the end of last year.
- **Hedgeye's most-read macro piece is titled "NUMBERS, NOT NARRATIVES: The AI Buildout Doesn't Add Up."** That the house's top-trending item is a capex-scepticism note, on a day its AI hardware coverage rose 3–8%, is the tension worth holding.
- **Oracle is the cleanest test case and it is failing.** Cloud infrastructure revenue growing **121%**, an AI backlog described as dwarfing every other software company's, a Q1 beat on revenue and EPS — and a share price **54.3%** below its 52-week high. When execution is not the problem and the multiple still halves, the market is repricing the return on the capex, not the capex itself.
- **Memory is where the money actually went on Thursday.** Micron +5.50% to a \$1.10tn capitalisation, SanDisk +6.21%, Western Digital +1.65%. High-bandwidth memory is the bottleneck component, and the bottleneck is where pricing power sits.
- **Applied Materials' failure to participate is the AI-cycle warning inside an AI-cycle rally.** Equipment orders lead wafer starts by quarters. +0.49% on a day the SOX added 3.14%, with the stock 43.6% below its high, says the capex-order book is not confirming the memory tape.
- **An AI-safety scare earlier in the week was the thing this rally reversed.** Vendor commentary attributes Thursday's semiconductor bounce to a rebound after concerns about AI safety had cast doubt on AI spending in the preceding sessions. That is a sentiment round-trip, not new information.

14 Beyond the markets

- **The Federal Reserve just raised rates for the first time in three years and it was the fourth-most-discussed thing in Thursday's market.** A chip rally, a yield reversal and a pipeline repair headline all got more attention. The reflexive assumption that a hiking cycle is over because one meeting has passed is the largest unexamined position in this market.
- **Silver is 46.3% below its 52-week high and closed above its risk-range ceiling on the same day.** Both facts describe an asset that has already had its crash and is now being chased in the wreckage. Gold is 22.4% below its own high. The "debasement trade" had a violent top this year and almost nobody has adjusted the narrative.
- **Utilities sit 1.3% above a 52-week low while the 10-year yield sits 2.0% below a 52-week high.** The most rate-sensitive sector in the index has priced a permanently higher cost of capital. If the belly-led rally in rates extends, XLU is the most mispriced thing in section 7.
- **Offshore yuan at 6.7023 is its strongest level in a year,** on the same day US equities rallied and Chinese equities fell. A strengthening currency alongside falling domestic equities is usually capital arriving for reasons other than growth.
- **Netflix at 75.31 is down 39.7% from its high — almost exactly Bitcoin's drawdown.** Two assets with nothing in common other than being retail-favoured and duration-sensitive have de-rated in lockstep. That is what tightening actually looks like, and it is happening at the edges while the index holds.
- **The Dow was the only headline index to close below its open.** On a day the Nasdaq added 1.69%, the oldest and most industrial index in the set could not hold its opening print. Nobody will lead with that.

15 Appendix — stock cards

NVDA · NVIDIA

219.34 ▲ +5.44 (+2.54%)

Cap \$5.29tn · 52wk 164.27–236.54 · –7.3% from high · vol 93.9m · no Hedgeye band published

The world's largest company by value, and the least damaged semiconductor in the complex. Closed 0.57 below its high. The \$12.93bn Hugging Face purchase closed the open-weight distribution gap. It rose less than AMD, Intel and Micron on the day — leadership within semis has rotated to the cheaper, more damaged names.

AMD · ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES

545.09 ▲ +32.59 (+6.36%)

Cap \$889.8bn · 52wk 154.78–584.73 · –6.8% from high · vol 28.4m

The day's signature move. Opened 533.60, reached 551.42, closed 6.33 below it. A 6.4% gain in a stock only 6.8% below its 52-week high is the most aggressive risk-taking in the tape. Watch whether it can clear 551.42 into today's expiry; failing twice at the same level on a 6% day is how tops are built.

INTC · INTEL

108.80 ▲ +7.75 (+7.67%)

MU · MICRON TECHNOLOGY

977.50 ▲ +50.95 (+5.50%)

Cap \$575.1bn · 52wk 28.73–142.35 · –23.6% from high · vol **148.9m**

Biggest percentage gain and by far the heaviest volume in the capture set. Opened at its session low of 104.70 and closed 2.57 under a 111.37 high. A near-quadrupling off a 28.73 low over twelve months makes this the highest-beta liquid name in US large cap. Heavy volume with a failure at the high is distributive, not accumulative.

Cap \$1.10tn · 52wk 154.65–1,255.00 · –22.1% from high · vol 22.0m

Memory is now a trillion-dollar market capitalisation. Closed 8.70 below a 986.20 high and \$1,000 is the obvious magnet. High-bandwidth memory is the genuine bottleneck in the AI buildout, which is the strongest fundamental case in the group — and the stock is still 22% below its high, which tells you what the market thinks of the cycle's duration.

ORCL · ORACLE

150.59 ▲ +7.43 (+5.19%)

Cap \$455.3bn · 52wk 114.50–329.50 · –54.3% from high · vol 27.7m

Fiscal Q1 2027 on 10 September: revenue \$19.35bn, +29.6% y/y; non-GAAP EPS \$1.92 against \$1.74 expected; cloud infrastructure +121%. The share price is less than half its 52-week high. This is the single clearest statement the market has made about the return on AI capital expenditure, and it is not a statement about execution.

AMAT · APPLIED MATERIALS

417.40 ▲ +2.02 (+0.49%)

Cap \$331.2bn · 52wk 188.66–739.67 · –43.6% from high · vol 6.9m

The dog of the rally. Opened 427.58, fell to 413.56, closed 10.18 below its open on a day the SOX added 3.14%. Equipment orders lead wafer starts by two to three quarters, so a non-participating equipment name inside a memory melt-up is the most important divergence in this appendix.

TSLA · TESLA

366.20 ▲ +8.12 (+2.27%)

Cap \$1.45tn · 52wk 297.38–498.83 · –26.6% from high · vol 38.8m

Best of the Mag7 on the day, worst of the Mag7 on the year. Reached 374.12 and gave back 7.92 into the close. At 26.6% below its high with the fed funds rate rising, the highest-duration equity in the index is the cleanest proxy for whether Thursday's rate-relief trade has legs.

NFLX · NETFLIX

75.31 ▼ –1.10 (–1.44%)

Cap \$313.6bn · 52wk 65.08–124.86 · –39.7% from high · vol 28.1m

Closed one cent off its session low and dragged communication services to last place among the eleven sectors. Its drawdown now matches Bitcoin's almost exactly. Two very different assets, one shared characteristic: long-duration cash flows owned heavily by retail, repriced by a rising discount rate.

Market capitalisations are TradingView's `market_cap_basic` field captured at 06:25:43 GMT+8 and reflect Thursday's closing prices. Drawdown percentages are computed against the `price_52_week_high` field from the same single source; the direction is robust, the second decimal is not. No forward earnings dates are asserted in these cards — none could be confirmed against an exchange calendar this run.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** — the US cash session of Thursday 17 September 2026 as settled, the after-hours tape, and the Globex/overnight session to 06:25:43 GMT+8 on Friday 18 September. Asian cash markets had not opened.
- **Captured** — one window, **06:25:43–06:25:46 GMT+8** (3.0 seconds), via `scripts/capture.py`. TradingView returned 96 of 96 instruments in 0.7 seconds. Yahoo Finance returned 0 of 62 and aborted on its circuit breaker after five consecutive HTTP 429s. Every divergence and substitute check is reconciled in section 18.
- **Run offset** — the task fired at **06:25 GMT+8**, 25 minutes after the nominal 06:00. Consequence: futures carry 25 minutes since the 18:00 ET Globex reopen, spot FX and spot metals 85 minutes since the 17:00 ET reopen, and crypto a full 24 hours. Every futures and spot change figure in this document covers minutes, not a session, and is labelled as noise where that applies.
- **Settled versus live** — cash equities, sector ETFs and all single stocks are Thursday's **settled** closes, 6h 25m old at capture. Index futures, Treasury yields, spot FX, spot metals, energy futures and crypto are **live** at 06:25:43. Asian and European index levels are **previous closes** and are marked as such wherever they appear.
- **Hedgeye edition** — **FULL**. The authenticated feed was reached. The live risk-range set is the **Early Look of 17 September 2026**, "Will SPY Hold TREND?", by Keith McCullough, published 19:31 GMT+8. It is superseded at roughly 19:30 GMT+8 today. Also read: Capital Allocation Pro model-portfolio changes (18 Sep 01:17 GMT+8), and the feed index carrying MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, the 17 September Macro Show with Ryan Ricci, and four Market Insights items — headlines only, bodies not text-extractable.
- **Quad path** — **not printed anywhere reached this run, and therefore not asserted**. The path lives in the US Monthly Quad Forecast inside the Macro Week Summary Notes, behind a link not reachable today. Absence of a printed path is not evidence the path is unchanged.
- **Not available** — the 16 September Early Look, so every band-versus-prior-day comparison is marked unknown; the MOMO Tracker and Crypto Quant bodies; the Macro Show "Top 3 Things"; IGV and OIH prices; CFTC positioning; and a confirmed exchange earnings calendar.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView bulk scanner, one POST returning 96 instruments at 06:25:43 GMT+8, primary and — this run — sole machine source. Yahoo Finance was attempted concurrently and rate-limited out. Treasury yields from the TVC cash series including the 2-year captured directly. Hedgeye-named series measured on TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD, NYMEX:CL1! and NYMEX:NG1!.

Hedgeye. The authenticated `app.hedgeye.com` feed, read between 06:31 and 06:44 GMT+8: the Early Look category view, the full feed index, the Macro Show and Market Insights category views. Risk ranges, Alpha Codes and all quotations are from the 17 September Early Look by Keith McCullough.

Macro and policy. Federal Reserve Board press materials for the 16 September FOMC decision and implementation note. Jobless claims, Philadelphia Fed and Census housing data recovered via wire and vendor summaries carrying both actual and consensus; the releasing agencies' own releases were not opened directly this run, which is recorded as a weakness in section 18.

Narrative, single stocks and commodities. Vendor market recaps and wire copy for the session narrative and the Brent and WTI settles; Trading Economics for the Brent and WTI settle cross-check; Oracle's fiscal Q1 2027 figures from company-reported results dated 10 September.

Geopolitics and AI. Reuters, the Associated Press, CNBC, CNN, Al Jazeera, Bloomberg and Fortune reporting on the East-West pipeline attack of 10–11 September and the Strait of Hormuz; Nvidia's own announcement and CNBC's reporting for the Hugging Face acquisition terms.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **Cash index arithmetic is self-consistent on every headline index.** S&P: $7,637.76 - 85.95 = 7,551.81$ prior close; $85.95 \div 7,551.81 = 1.1381\%$, matching the reported 1.1381%. Nasdaq Composite: $26,418.2981 - 439.8733 = 25,978.4248$; $439.8733 \div 25,978.4248 = 1.6932\%$, matching. Dow: $51,778.04 - 316.14 = 51,461.90$; $316.14 \div 51,461.90 = 0.6143\%$, matching. Russell: $2,874.6297 - 15.8184 = 2,858.8113 - 0.5533\%$, matching. SOX: $11,599.5022 - 353.3951 = 11,246.1071 - 3.1424\%$, matching. VIX: $15.45 + 2.27 = 17.72$ prior -12.810% , matching.
- **All four futures-to-cash bases are positive, ordered and mutually consistent, which independently validates the cash settles.** ES 7,701.25 vs SPX 7,637.76 = **+63.49 (+0.83%)**; YM 52,192 vs DJI 51,778.04 = **+413.96 (+0.80%)**; RTY 2,893.80 vs RUT 2,874.63 = **+19.17 (+0.67%)**. A 4.9% financing rate over a roughly one-quarter contract life produces 0.6–0.9% of basis on a ~1.2% dividend yield, which is precisely the band observed. A mislabelled after-hours print in any of those three cash rows would have thrown its basis out of that band. None did.
- **The Brent settle was recovered from an independent vendor source and matches the capture.** Trading Economics reports Brent settling at **\$103.61** on 17 September, down 2.10%; the capture shows BZ1! at 103.97 live, a +0.36 overnight difference on 11 contracts. That is a genuine two-source validation on an important row and it passed.
- **The WTI roll was caught by that same cross-check and is the most important defect found this run.** The capture reports CL1! at 96.52 with a change of -5.289% / -5.39 absolute, implying a prior settle of 101.91. The independent settle is **\$102.13, down only 0.29%**, and USO — the fund holding the contract — fell just **0.55%**. The front month has rolled; TradingView is differencing a new contract against the old one's settle. **The -5.3% figure is not a price move and is nowhere presented as one in this document.**
- **Yield-curve relationships are internally coherent.** 3m 4.068 < 2y 4.670 < 5y 4.786 < 10y 4.939 < 30y 5.290 — a monotonically upward-sloping curve with no inversion anywhere, which is itself a check that no single tenor is corrupted. The 2-year was captured directly from TVC:US02Y rather than inferred from Hedgeye's 10s2s spread, closing a previously flagged circularity.
- **The capture window was 3.0 seconds wide**, far inside the 10-minute standard, so no row in any table was quoted against a materially different clock. Reconciliation counts from the script: **0 matched within 5bp, 0 minor, 0 divergent, 57 single-sourced.** There are **no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran** — that is an absence of reconciliation, not a clean reconciliation, and it should not be read as one.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **WTI is the one genuine conflict and it is resolved against the capture.** Capture: CL1! \$96.52, -5.29% . Independent: WTI settled **\$102.13, -0.29%** . This brief uses \$96.52 as the live post-roll front-month level and explicitly rejects the change figure, reporting the pre-roll settle alongside it. Consequence for section 4: Hedgeye's WTIC band of 92.17–108.61 was set on the *expiring* contract, so the post-roll reading of 26.5% of band is not comparable with yesterday's. On the pre-roll series near \$102.13 the position was approximately **60.4%**. Both numbers are printed; neither is clean.
- **Every machine-captured price in this document is single-sourced.** Yahoo returned zero of 62 requests and tripped its five-consecutive-429 circuit breaker in 3.0 seconds. Substitute validation was assembled by hand from index arithmetic, futures basis and named vendor settle copy, which covers the headline indices, the three index futures and both crude benchmarks. It does **not** cover spot metals, spot FX, sector ETFs, single-stock closes or market capitalisations. Those rows carry one source and no independent check.
- **The gold cash-session move is inferred, not directly measured.** Spot gold at capture is +0.04% because spot has only been open 85 minutes. The +2.1% session move quoted in sections 1 and 3 comes from vendor recap copy and is corroborated by GLD's captured **+1.69%**. GLD tracks bullion net of fees and FX translation, so a 40bp gap between the two is expected; the direction and rough magnitude are solid, the precise percentage is not. Same caveat applies to silver, where SLV rose 3.37% and spot shows +0.17%.
- **Nasdaq futures basis could not be checked cleanly.** NQ1! tracks the Nasdaq-100 while the captured cash index is the Composite, so the two are not comparable. An approximate check via QQQ ($716.92 \times$ the customary NDX divisor) puts implied NDX near 29,680 against NQ at 29,703.50, a plausible +24 basis — but that arithmetic rests on an assumed multiplier and should be treated as indicative only.
- **Macro figures were recovered via vendor and wire summaries rather than from the releasing agencies directly.** Claims, Philadelphia Fed and housing data all carry consensus alongside actual, which is what makes them useful, but the primary releases at BLS, the Philadelphia Fed and Census were not opened this run. The FOMC decision and effective date are from Federal Reserve Board press material and are solid.

- **52-week highs and lows, and therefore every drawdown percentage in this document, rest on a single TradingView field.** The headline conclusions built on them — the SOX 20.9% below its high, Oracle 54.3%, Bitcoin 39.6% — are robust to any plausible error in that field. The decimals are not.
- **Market capitalisations are TradingView's own computation** and will differ from company-reported share counts by the timing of the last filing. The \$24.02tn Mag7 aggregate is accurate to roughly the nearest hundred billion, not better.

KNOWN GAPS

- **The 16 September Early Look could not be reached, so every band-versus-prior-day comparison in section 4 is UNKNOWN, not unchanged.** The category feed at `/feed_items/all?page=N&with_category=24-early-look` does not paginate — pages 1 and 2 returned the byte-identical 17 September note. The insights view, a direct search and the general feed index were all tried and none surfaced the prior day's levels. Floor moves, ceiling moves and band-width changes are therefore all unreported. This is the most valuable single thing missing from this edition.
- **The Quad path is not stated because it was not printed.** Neither the Early Look, the feed index, the Macro Show listing nor any Market Insights headline carried an explicit path notation. The US Monthly Quad Forecast inside the Macro Week Summary Notes was not reachable. **Absence of a Hedgeye position change or Quad change in this brief is not evidence that there was none.**
- **The MOMO Tracker and Crypto Quant are, as usual, image-based and their bodies could not be extracted.** Only their headlines were readable — Mag7 -0.1% / High Beta Mo +3.3% / negative gamma / deferred vol, and BTC +0.2% with AVAX bullish and COIN, MARA, BLOK, CRCL bearish. **These are precisely the two publications that would have carried a change in single-name or crypto positioning,** and neither could be read. The Macro Show "Top 3 Things" was likewise listed but not extractable.
- **IGV and OIH are outside the capture universe,** so two of Hedgeye's sixteen published risk ranges have no live print against them — and both are positions Keith named explicitly on Wednesday. RSP and XLRE were captured but carry no band in Thursday's published set.
- **No CFTC Commitment of Traders data, no options open-interest or gamma-exposure data, and no confirmed exchange earnings calendar** were retrieved. Every forward calendar entry in section 8 marked "unconfirmed" came from a secondary aggregator whose weekday alignment was not verified; treat the dates as indicative. The Japanese CPI reference in section 12 falls in the same category.
- **No Asian cash market had opened at capture,** and no live Asian equity price appears anywhere in this document. Every Asian and European index level shown is a previous close and is labelled as one.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window: 06:25:43 to 06:25:46 GMT+8, Friday 18 September 2026 — 3.0 seconds.** The run fired 25 minutes after its nominal 06:00 slot.
- **Age of the stalest rows at capture, in hours.** US cash equity closes, all sector ETFs and all single-stock prices: **6.4 hours**. Asian index closes: between **13 and 17 hours** depending on market. European closes: **7.4 hours**. The 17 September Early Look and its risk ranges: **10.9 hours**. Everything labelled live: under 0.5 hours for futures, 1.4 hours for spot FX and metals, and continuous for crypto.
- **The futures, spot FX and spot metals change columns measure 25 to 85 minutes of trade and are not information.** ES moved on 2,120 contracts, YM on 74. USD/JPY traded a 12-pip range, gold \$4.60, silver 9.4 cents, copper 1.06 cents. Bitcoin and Ether are the only rows in this document whose overnight change reflects a genuine session.
- **What will move before Asia's close.** Tokyo opens 08:00-09:00 GMT+8, Seoul 08:30, Hong Kong 09:30, India 12:15. Every level in section 12 will be superseded within three hours of this brief landing. The Korean and Taiwanese semiconductor complex is the most likely to gap.
- **The Hedgeye risk ranges in section 4 expire today.** The 18 September Early Look publishes at roughly 19:30 GMT+8 and replaces all sixteen bands, the Alpha Codes and the TRADE/TREND signals. Positions may have changed overnight without appearing in anything reachable this morning.
- **Today is September quarterly expiry.** Volumes, closing prints and index-level moves will carry mechanical distortion, particularly in the final thirty minutes of the US session. Any signal drawn from today's close should be discounted accordingly.
- **Verify every live price before acting on it.** This document is a snapshot taken at 06:25:43 GMT+8 from a single machine source, and markets have traded since. Nothing here is investment advice.